

Logistics, Shipping and Carrier Policy

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Purpose

This policy defines how TraceStock AI ships orders, which site fulfils which order, what delivery promises may be made, how carrier failures are handled, and what shipping costs apply. It sits alongside the Order Fulfillment and Customer Promise Policy, which governs the promise made to the customer; this document governs how that promise is physically met.

Site Allocation Rules

Orders are allocated to a fulfilment site in the following order of preference.

- The site nearest the delivery address that holds the full order in stock
- The site nearest the delivery address that holds the largest part of the order
- Berlin Hub, as overflow, where no site can fulfil economically

Splitting an order across sites is permitted but discouraged, because it multiplies shipping cost and creates two delivery events for the customer to track. An order may only be split when the alternative is a delay beyond the promised date, or when a single line exceeds what one site holds.

Regional preference by delivery region:

Delivery region	Primary site	Secondary
Northern Germany	Hamburg Warehouse	Berlin Hub
Eastern Germany	Berlin Hub	Hamburg Warehouse
Western Germany	Frankfurt DC	Berlin Hub
Southern Germany	Munich Fulfillment	Frankfurt DC

Carrier Selection

Carriers are selected by parcel characteristics rather than by preference.

Parcel type	Carrier tier	Typical transit	Notes
Standard parcel under 5 kg	Standard	1-2 business days	Majority of consumer orders
Parcel 5-31.5 kg	Standard heavy	2-3 business days	Most Air Conditioners, Office Chairs

Parcel type	Carrier tier	Typical transit	Notes
Over 31.5 kg or oversized	Freight	3-5 business days	Requires delivery appointment
High value over 1,000 EUR	Insured, signature	1-2 business days	Signature mandatory, no safe-place delivery
B2B pallet	Freight	3-5 business days	Delivery window agreed in advance

Signature is mandatory above 1,000 EUR and may not be waived at customer request, because the company carries the loss where no proof of delivery exists.

Delivery Promises

A delivery promise may only be made when stock is confirmed at an allocating site. Promises made against stock that is inbound but not received are not permitted, regardless of how reliable the inbound is expected to be.

Cut-off for same-day dispatch is 14:00 CET Monday to Friday. Orders placed after cut-off, at weekends, or on public holidays are treated as placed on the next business day.

Standard promise by region, measured in business days from dispatch:

- Same region as fulfilling site: 1 day
- Adjacent region: 1-2 days
- Cross-country: 2-3 days
- Freight and oversized: 3-5 days, appointment required

Weather and carrier network disruption extend these. When a known disruption is active, the promise must reflect it at the point of sale rather than being corrected afterwards.

Shipping Cost

Order value	Consumer shipping cost
Under 50 EUR	4.95 EUR
50-150 EUR	2.95 EUR
Over 150 EUR	Free
Oversized or freight	29.95 EUR regardless of value

B2B shipping is quoted per agreement and is not subject to the consumer table.

Free shipping thresholds are calculated on the order value after discounts, not before. A discount that takes an order below the threshold reintroduces the shipping charge, and this must be shown before the customer confirms.

Return Shipping

Who pays for return shipping depends on the reason for return.

Return reason	Who pays
Defective product	Company
Wrong item shipped	Company
Damaged in transit	Company
Changed mind	Customer
No longer needed	Customer
Ordered wrong item by customer	Customer
Product not as described	Company

Where the company pays, a prepaid label is issued rather than reimbursing the customer afterwards. Reimbursement after the fact generates avoidable support contacts and delays the refund.

Oversized returns require collection rather than drop-off, arranged by Logistics. A customer must never be asked to arrange freight themselves.

Transit Damage

Damage in transit is the company's responsibility toward the customer, regardless of which party is liable toward the carrier. The customer is made whole first and the carrier claim is pursued separately.

Reported transit damage requires:

- Photographs of the packaging and the item
- The tracking reference
- Report within 14 calendar days of delivery

A replacement is dispatched on receipt of the report, without waiting for the damaged item to be returned, where the order value is under 500 EUR. Above that, the damaged item is collected first.

Lost Shipments

A shipment is treated as lost when tracking shows no movement for 7 consecutive business days, or when the carrier confirms loss, whichever is sooner.

On loss, the customer is offered a replacement at no cost or a full refund including original shipping. The customer chooses. Waiting for the carrier investigation to conclude before resolving with the customer is not permitted; those are separate processes on separate timescales.

Failed Delivery Attempts

Carriers attempt delivery up to three times before returning a parcel. Where a parcel returns to the site undelivered:

- The customer is contacted within 1 business day to arrange redelivery
- Redelivery is free on the first occasion

- A second redelivery after a further failed attempt may be charged at the

standard rate

- If unreachable after 10 calendar days, the order is refunded less original

shipping and the stock is returned to sellable inventory subject to the inspection rules in the Warehouse Inventory Control SOP

Peak Period Handling

During November and December, carrier networks run at capacity and transit times extend by 1 to 2 days. Delivery promises must be extended accordingly from 1 November, not adjusted reactively once delays appear.

Promotional events during peak require Logistics sign-off on the expected parcel volume before launch. A promotion that generates volume the network cannot absorb converts a revenue success into a support incident.

Hazardous and Restricted Goods

Some catalogue items carry shipping restrictions.

- Products containing lithium batteries, including some Laptops, Smartphones,

and Headphones, may not ship by air freight and require compliant labelling

- Aerosol Sunscreen products are restricted and must ship by ground only
- Air Conditioners containing refrigerant require declaration on freight

documentation

Restricted items may not be shipped outside the standard ground network even where a customer requests express delivery and offers to pay.

Document Control

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